VerdiktNow

CONFIDENTIAL ASSESSMENT REPORT

Vendor invoice processing

Business case and implementation plan

READINESS SCORE	VALUE SCORE	NET SAVINGS / YEAR
74/100	46/100	26,096 $
Good candidate	project profitability	after license and maintenance

STATUS
● **Plan**

CATEGORY
Finance & accounting

PREPARED FOR
Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable)

TARGET TIMELINE
Not specified

GENERATED ON
2026-08-30T20:30:00.982Z

CURRENCY
CAD

ASSESSMENT RELIABILITY
Medium

Table of contents

This report presents a structured assessment of the readiness of "Vendor invoice processing" for automation, a profitability analysis, a prioritization recommendation, and an action plan.

Executive summary

Plan: 26,096 $ in net savings per year, return on investment in 13.8 months.

OVERALL RECOMMENDATION

Plan

Plan

Based on an individual self-assessment of the diagnostic. Should be validated by other process stakeholders before any budget commitment.

Assessment reliability: Medium. Diagnostic complete (30/30) · Context partial (6/16 fields) · Process steps detailed · AI analysis applied to the context · Self-assessment by a single respondent.

Expected ease of adoption: High. Standardized process: few variations to explain to users. · Low risk: approval and user trust are quicker to obtain. · Frequent exceptions reported: targeted training needed on edge cases..

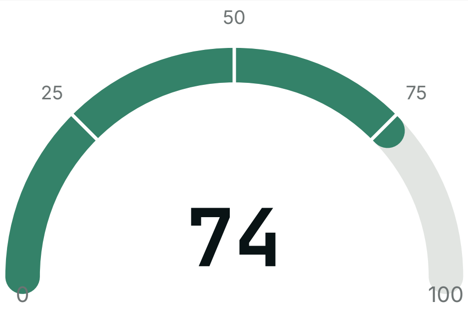
READINESS SCORE	VALUE SCORE (ROI)	NET SAVINGS / YEAR	RETURN ON INVESTMENT
74/100	46/100	26,096 $	13.8 months
Good candidate	derived from financial assumptions	after license and maintenance	payback period

Key points

- Recommended automation approach: **Rules-based automation (RPA)**.
- Main strength: Standardization & stability (75/100).
- The project generates positive net savings from year 1, with a net present value over 5 years of 74,192 $.
- Declared regulatory constraints (SOX / regulated finance): the Risk & governance lever is capped at 70/100 despite a more favorable self-assessment. Verify this answer before committing.

The detailed analysis and a three-phase action plan are presented in the following sections, notably the roadmap (section 05).

Score of 74/100, driven by Standardization & stability (75/100)

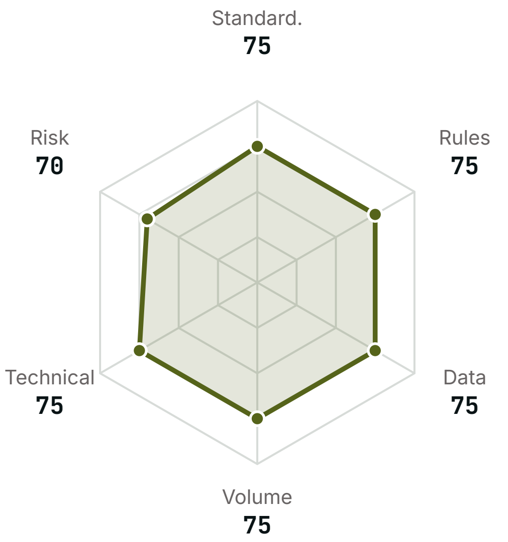


Level 4 · Good candidate

This process is well suited to automation.

30/30 statements answered

Lever profile



Standardization & stability (22%)	75
Rules & decisions (20%)	75
Data & inputs (18%)	75
Volume & repetitiveness (15%)	75
Technical feasibility (13%)	75
Risk & governance (12%)	70

Strengths

- **Standardization & stability · 75/100**
  A stable, documented workflow is the safest foundation for a reliable automation: few unexpected cases to handle, little corrective maintenance to plan for.
- **Rules & decisions · 75/100**
  Explicit decision rules enable direct automation via a rules engine, without relying on a probabilistic model to decide.
- **Data & inputs · 75/100**
  Digital, structured inputs greatly reduce the project's technical failure risk and speed up integration.
- **Volume & repetitiveness · 75/100**
  High, repetitive volume maximizes the return on the automation effort: every hour invested in the project pays back faster.
- **Technical feasibility · 75/100**
  Available technical integration points reduce implementation risk and cost: less custom development to plan for.
- **Risk & governance · 70/100**
  Low risk and clear governance simplify project approval and enable a broader, faster rollout.

Areas for improvement

No major blocker identified.

RECOMMENDED AUTOMATION APPROACH

Rules-based automation (RPA)

Explicit rules and structured data: a classic software robot (RPA) or a rules engine is enough, no AI needed.

- Rules & decisions: 75/100 (explicit decisions).
- Standardization: 75/100 (stable workflow).
- Data & inputs: 75/100 (structured inputs).
- Systems mentioned (SAP, Excel, courriel Outlook): integration points available, consistent with a rules-based automation.

WHY THIS APPROACH

This approach is selected when the three levers Rules & Decisions, Standardization, and Data & Inputs each reach at least 55/100: the process follows explicit rules, a stable workflow, and already-structured data — the classic conditions for an RPA bot, with no need for artificial intelligence. Had the Data lever fallen below this threshold, intelligent document processing (IDP) would have been proposed instead; had it been the Rules lever that fell short, an AI agent would have been more fitting.

Declared regulatory constraints (SOX / regulated finance): the Risk & governance lever is capped at 70/100 despite a more favorable self-assessment. Verify this answer before committing.

Flow diagram

Source systems	→	Automation	→	Result
SAP, Excel, courriel Outlook		**Rules-based automation (RPA)**		Volume processed automatically, human oversight on exceptions.

Documented steps

STEP	WHO	SYSTEM	MIN.	AUTO.	FRICTION
Receiving and sorting invoices	Agent AP	Outlook	8	No	Inconsistent formats (PDF, scanned paper)
Three-way match	Agent AP	SAP	12	Yes	-
Approval and payment	Superviseur	SAP	6	Yes	Approval wait time

Total: 26 min per occurrence, as documented by the user. "Auto." indicates whether the step follows a constant rule and uses already-digital data.

Tools already in place

What you already own, sorted by the role it could play in an automation. This reading deliberately comes before the tool leads: the cheapest engine is often the one already installed and already paid for.

integrable

SAP · Outlook / Microsoft email
This tool does not automate on its own, but it exposes interfaces (APIs, standard connectors): an automation platform can read from and write to it without manual intervention.

data source

Excel
This tool holds the information but orchestrates nothing. It can serve as the starting or ending point of an automation, never as the engine — and a shared file remains fragile as the centrepiece of a process.

No automation engine is declared, but 2 of your tools expose integration interfaces: a lightweight platform would probably be enough to connect them, without replacing what you have.

Tool shortlist

Microsoft Power Automate — Entry level, integrated with Microsoft 365

You mentioned Outlook / Microsoft email: Microsoft integration already in place, easier adoption.

Environment: Part of Microsoft's Power Platform (alongside Power Apps, Power BI, Dataverse). Cloud-native SaaS, per-user or per-flow licensing, deep integration with Microsoft 365/Teams/SharePoint/Dynamics — the natural choice if the organization already runs on Microsoft.

Limits: Requires Microsoft 365/Power Platform licensing; less robust than dedicated RPA platforms for complex multi-system scenarios or high volumes.

UiPath — Mid to high end, mature ecosystem

You mentioned SAP: built for large-scale integrations.

Environment: Independent RPA platform (not tied to a particular cloud vendor), deployable on-premise or in the cloud. Broadest connector marketplace in RPA (SAP, Salesforce, legacy systems) and the largest trained talent pool on the market.

Limits: Significant licensing cost at scale; longer learning curve for an in-house team, often needs an integrator to get started.

Automation Anywhere — High end, geared toward large enterprises

You mentioned SAP: built for large-scale integrations.

Environment: Cloud-native platform (Automation 360), built for centralized governance across hundreds of bots. Marketplace of pre-built bots; often chosen by IT departments planning very large-scale deployment from day one.

Limits: Pricing and deployment geared toward large enterprises; typically overkill for a first bot or low volume.

Indicative, non-exhaustive selection, to be validated against your needs, purchasing constraints, and existing integrations; not a purchase recommendation. VerdiktNow receives no commission or benefit from any of these vendors.

Questions to ask a vendor

- [ ] Who, on their side, will be responsible for support after go-live, and for how long?
- [ ] What happens if you switch vendors: are the automations developed portable?
- [ ] What is the real cost after implementation (licenses, maintenance, support), not just the entry price?
- [ ] Have they already automated a similar process (same industry, same systems)? Ask for a verifiable reference.
- [ ] Who maintains the robot once it's in production: them, your internal team, or both?
- [ ] What is the guaranteed fix turnaround if the robot fails (SLA)?

Bring this page to your first meeting with a vendor or consultant: it summarizes what they need to know to give you a relevant proposal, without having to rediscover the process context.

26,096 $ in net savings per year, payback in 13.8 months

NET RECURRING SAVINGS / YEAR

26,096 $

PAYBACK
13.8 months

NPV · 5 YEARS
74,192 $

HOURS / YEAR
1,564 h

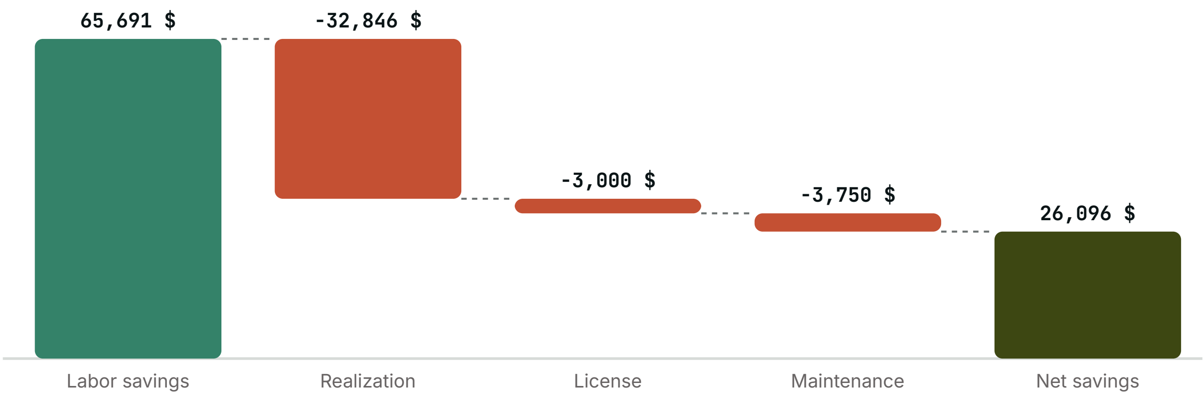
FTES FREED UP
.98

CURRENT PROCESS COST
93,845 $

VALUE SCORE
46/100

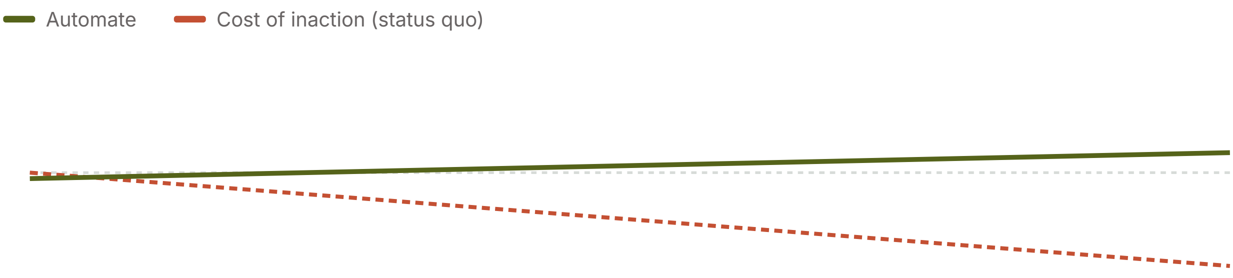
Current cost breakdown: 88,200 $ of normal processing + 5,645 $ of error rework (8% error rate).

Value bridge



From gross labor savings, license and maintenance are subtracted to arrive at net recurring savings.

Cumulative cash flow · 60 months



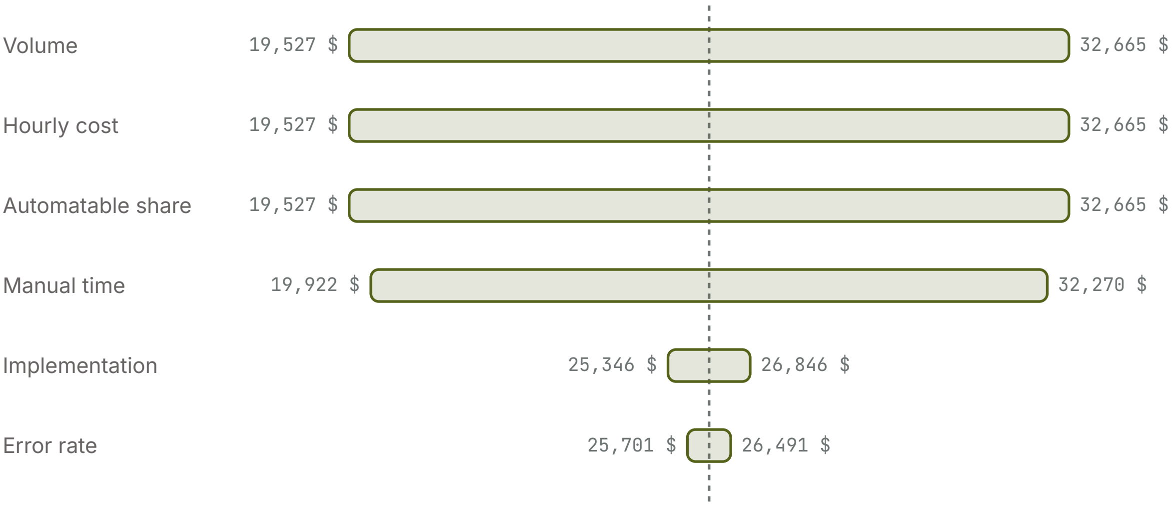
0 to 60 months · payback threshold ≈ 13.8 months. Estimated gap over 5 years between automating and doing nothing: **569,702 $**.

Scenario range

CONSERVATIVE	LIKELY	OPTIMISTIC
16,242 $	26,096 $	32,665 $

The scenarios vary the achievable automation rate (± 30%), the model's most uncertain assumption, with all other variables held constant.

Sensitivity analysis



Each bar varies a single assumption by ±20%, with the others held constant, around the current net savings (dashed line: 26,096 $). Sorted by impact: the assumption at the top is the one to validate first before committing.

Assumptions

Volume / month
420

Manual time / occ.
25 min

Fully loaded hourly cost
42 $

Error rate
8%

Rework / error
20 min

Automatable share
70%

Implementation
25,000 $

License / year
3,000 $

Annual maintenance
15%

Change management
5,000 $

Discount rate
8%

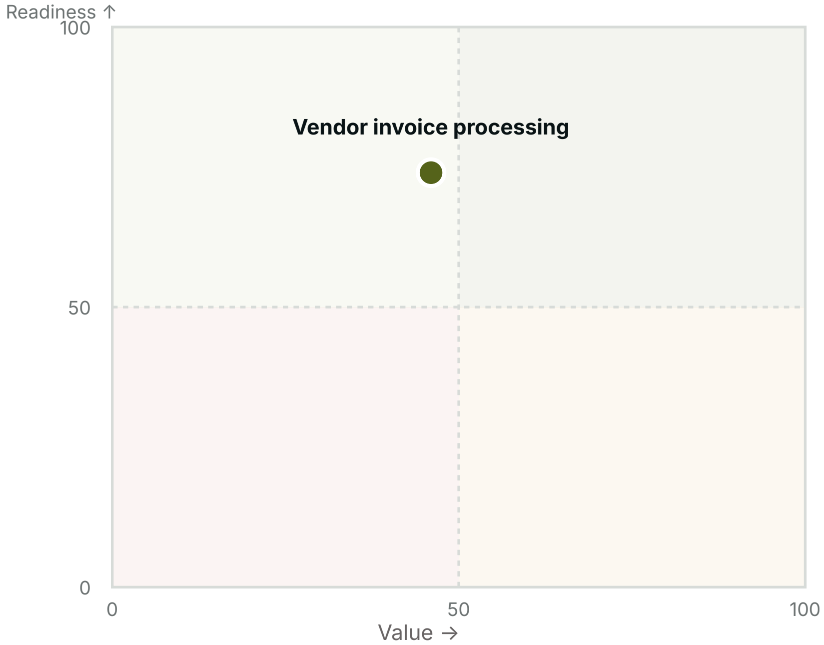
Plan: value × readiness positioning

RECOMMENDATION

Plan

Plan

Value × Readiness matrix



READINESS
74/100

VALUE
46/100

NET SAVINGS / YEAR
26,096 $

The 4 quadrants

Automate first
High value and good readiness: this is a quick win. This process should top your roadmap.

Plan
High readiness but more modest value: easy to automate, schedule it when capacity allows.

Prepare the ground
Attractive value but insufficient readiness: invest first in preparation (data, rules, standardization) before automating.

Set aside for now
Low value and readiness: automation isn't justified as things stand. Reassess after improving the process.

1 priority risk to address before implementation

Risk register, responsibility breakdown, and compliance points derived from the diagnostic and the context provided, to be validated and enriched with your teams before any commitment.

Risk register

RISK & MITIGATION	PROBABILITY	IMPACT	OWNER
Declared regulatory constraints (SOX / regulated finance): the Risk & governance lever is capped at 70/100 despite a more favorable self-assessment. Verify this answer before committing. Involve compliance and plan for enhanced human oversight before a broad rollout.	High	High	Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable)

Probability and impact are heuristics derived from the diagnostic, not an actuarial assessment. Sorted by descending priority.

RACI matrix

ACTIVITY	R	A	C	I
Scoping & scope validation	AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director	Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable)	IT team / automation developer	Leadership / steering committee
Development / configuration	IT team / automation developer	Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable)	AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director	Leadership / steering committee
Testing & validation	IT team / automation developer	Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable)	AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director	Leadership / steering committee
Deployment & go-live	IT team / automation developer	AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director	IT team / automation developer	Leadership / steering committee
Ongoing supervision & maintenance	IT team / automation developer	Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable)	Compliance / security	Leadership / steering committee

R = Responsible (executes) · A = Accountable (answers for it) · C = Consulted · I = Informed.

Compliance checklist

- [ ] Confirm the sensitivity classification of the data processed (personal, financial, health).
- [ ] Validate data retention and location (residency, subprocessors).
- [ ] Check whether a record of processing or an impact assessment (DPIA) is required if personal data is involved.
- [ ] Check audit trail and regulatory retention requirements (accounting standards, tax).
- [ ] Involve internal audit: a SOX control may require a specific audit trail on the automated steps.

Indicative list, to be validated with your legal and compliance teams based on your industry and jurisdiction.

Operational security

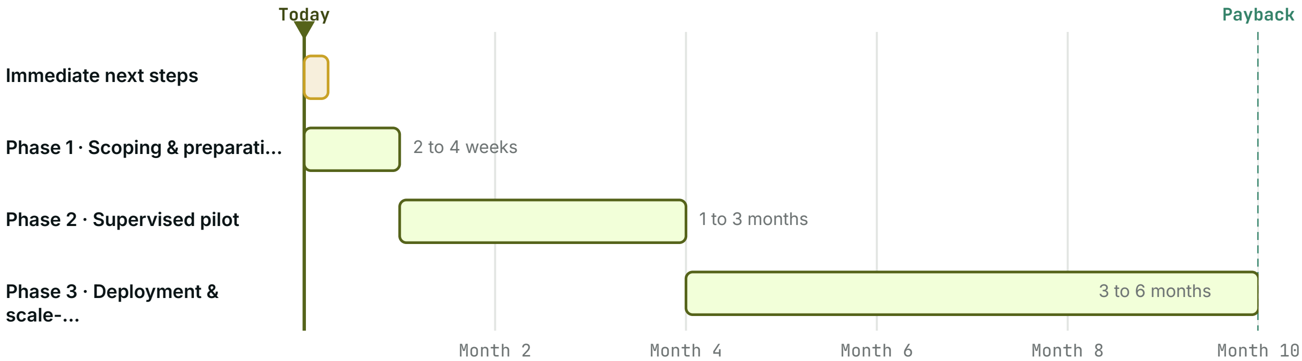
- [ ] Restrict the automation's access to the strict necessary scope (principle of least privilege).
- [ ] Define who can modify or disable the automation, and how that access is revoked (departure, role change).
- [ ] Ensure the automation's actions are logged and traceable (who/what/when).
- [ ] Check the security certifications of the vendor(s) (e.g. SOC 2, ISO 27001) if sensitive data passes through them.
- [ ] Separate test and production environments to avoid a trial run affecting real data.
- [ ] Use a dedicated service account for the robot's actions, never an employee's personal credentials.

Complements the compliance checklist above (regulatory) with operational security best practices for the automation's own access and data.

Action plan in 3 phases, 3 immediate steps

Three-phase action plan, derived from the lever profile, the recommended approach, and the financial assumptions above. To adjust with stakeholders during scoping.

Timeline overview



An indicative estimate starting from this report's generation date, not a calendar commitment.

IMMEDIATE NEXT STEPS

- [ ] Share this report with Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable) and confirm the go/no-go for the scoping phase.
- [ ] Block off a 2-week window for detailed pilot scoping.
- [ ] Set a target timeline for the pilot (typically 4 to 8 weeks after scoping).

Phase 1 · Scoping & preparation

2 to 4 weeks

- Confirm Julie Bergeron (Director of Accounts Payable) as project sponsor and governance point of contact.
- Validate the exact scope of the process with the identified stakeholders (AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director).
- Define an exit plan before starting: at what signal would the pilot be halted, and how would the manual process resume if needed?
- Assess the human impact on the people who currently perform this process (AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director): which tasks change, and how to support the transition (redeployment, training, communication).
- Validate the available integration points for the mentioned systems: SAP, Excel, courriel Outlook.
- No critical lever identified: the process is ready to move directly to the pilot.
- Reach out to one or more automation solution vendors to explore available options and request a demo.
- Select the chosen vendor and formalize the agreement: scope, costs, timeline, and contract terms.

Phase 2 · Supervised pilot

1 to 3 months

- Organize the pilot kickoff with the selected vendor: kickoff meeting, system access, and test environment.
- Develop a software robot (RPA) or rules engine on a representative subset of the volume.
- Prioritize reducing the declared pain points: Manual re-entry of data, multi-day approval delays.

- Document the handling of edge cases during the pilot, before full automation: Invoice without purchase order: manually validated by the supervisor.
- Plan for human oversight across all cases handled during the pilot, with a weekly review of deviations.
- Review the pilot with the vendor and stakeholders, then decide on the go/no-go for full deployment.

Phase 3 · Deployment & scale-up

3 to 6 months

- Go live with the full deployment, with vendor support if needed.
- Gradually extend automation to the full volume, in waves, while monitoring error rate and processing time.
- Update documentation and train the relevant teams on the new control points.
- Designate who operates and maintains the automation on an ongoing basis: a dedicated center of excellence or an existing business team, with a clear point of contact for incidents.
- Track net savings achieved against the target (26,096 $/year) and adjust assumptions as needed.
- Reassess this process in VerdiktNow after deployment to document how readiness and gains have evolved.

Appendix

Process context

PROJECT SPONSOR'S NAME
Julie Bergeron

SPONSOR'S TITLE AND DEPARTMENT
Director of Accounts Payable

STAKEHOLDERS AND ROLES
AP Agent, Supervisor, Finance Director

SYSTEMS AND APPLICATIONS USED
SAP, Excel, courriel Outlook

CURRENT PAIN POINTS AND FRICTION
Manual re-entry of data, multi-day approval delays

FREQUENT EXCEPTIONS AND EDGE CASES
Invoice without purchase order: manually validated by the supervisor

Detailed diagnostic answers

Standardization & stability · 75/100

This process is documented and follows a stable workflow.	3/4 · Largely
The steps are executed consistently from one time to the next.	3/4 · Largely
Exceptions are rare or clearly defined.	3/4 · Largely
The process changes little over time (low volatility).	3/4 · Largely
All stakeholders follow the same procedure.	3/4 · Largely

Rules & decisions · 75/100

Decisions rely on explicit rules, not judgment.	3/4 · Largely
The possible scenarios are known and finite in number.	3/4 · Largely
Little discretionary human intervention is required.	3/4 · Largely
Validation criteria are formalized.	3/4 · Largely
Decision sequences are reproducible.	3/4 · Largely

Data & inputs · 75/100

The process's inputs are digital (not paper).	3/4 · Largely
The required data is accessible at the right time.	3/4 · Largely
The inputs are structured and standardized.	3/4 · Largely
The quality of the input data is reliable.	3/4 · Largely
Little manual re-entry is required.	3/4 · Largely

Volume & repetitiveness · 75/100

The process repeats frequently.	3/4 · Largely
The volume handled is high.	3/4 · Largely
The cumulative time spent on this process is significant.	3/4 · Largely
The tasks are repetitive and predictable.	3/4 · Largely
Load spikes are recurring.	3/4 · Largely

Technical feasibility · 75/100

The systems involved offer integration points (API, connectors).	3/4 · Largely
No major technical blocker is anticipated.	3/4 · Largely
Security and compliance allow for automation.	3/4 · Largely
The required tools are available or accessible.	3/4 · Largely
A team or vendor capable of deploying the automation is already identified.	3/4 · Largely

Risk & governance · 70/100

The data processed is not highly sensitive or regulated (GDPR, health, critical finance).	3/4 · Largely
Automating this process does not require specific regulatory approval or audit.	3/4 · Largely
The consequences of an automated error are limited and recoverable.	3/4 · Largely
Stakeholders (business, IT, compliance) support automating this process.	3/4 · Largely
There is clear governance or a point of contact to oversee the automation.	3/4 · Largely

Sources and assumptions

The readiness score aggregates 6 levers (standardization, rules & decisions, data & inputs, volume & repetitiveness, technical feasibility, risk & governance), each assessed by 5 weighted statements scored from 0 to 4. The overall score is the weighted average of the answered levers.

The recommended automation approach (RPA, intelligent document extraction, AI agent, or hybrid approach) is determined from the shape of the lever profile, not just the overall average: two processes with the same score may call for different approaches.

The value score (ROI) combines the payback period and the magnitude of net recurring savings, after deducting license and maintenance costs. The conservative / likely / optimistic scenarios vary the achievable automation rate, the assumption judged most uncertain.

ADJUSTMENTS APPLIED BY CONTEXT

Risk & governance: 75/100 self-assessed, capped at 70/100
Declared regulatory constraints (SOX / regulated finance)

FINANCIAL ASSUMPTIONS (ROI)

Volume / month **420**	Manual time / occ. **25 min**	Fully loaded hourly cost **42 $**
Error rate **8%**	Rework / error **20 min**	Automatable share **70%**
Implementation **25,000 $**	License / year **3,000 $**	Annual maintenance **15%**
Change management **5,000 $**	Discount rate **8%**	